

COMP50004: Operating Systems

Q1. In Part a, some students lost marks by not explaining the purpose of synchronisation primitives. In Part b, answers should not assume a semaphore implementation. The rest of the question was answered well, but some students did not explain the role of the OS scheduler. Under (iv), some answers incorrectly proposed to use non-blocking I/O operations.

Q2. No marks were awarded for simple questions whose solution did not follow the requirements stated on the exam, and partial marks were awarded for solutions that were not entirely correct. Part a) had many incorrect answers that ignored that the miss path also incurs the cost of a cache lookup. Many answers in part b) explicitly disregarded the OS as not being software, which is not correct. Many students proposed using paging in part c), which is incorrect. Parts d) and e) had the most partially incorrect answers, often due to misunderstanding the workings of an inode file system or the role of mmap, respectively.